

Grade 5 students often struggle with understanding text structures, particularly in expository texts, which affects their overall reading comprehension and ability to organize information. Many learners find it difficult to identify relationships such as cause-and-effect, compare-and-contrast, and problem-solution, leading to poor comprehension and difficulty in summarizing texts. Research shows that explicit instruction in text structures significantly improves comprehension among struggling readers in upper elementary levels, as it helps students recognize how information is organized and presented [1]. Without this foundational skill, students may continue to experience challenges in interpreting academic texts across different subject areas, making text structure instruction a critical component of literacy development.

To address these challenges, gamification has been increasingly used as an instructional strategy, as it enhances student engagement, motivation, and learning outcomes. Gamification integrates elements such as points, rewards, levels, and interactive activities into the learning process, making it more enjoyable and meaningful for students. Studies have demonstrated that gamified learning environments significantly improve reading performance, comprehension, and critical thinking skills among elementary students [2][3]. In addition, gamified digital systems encourage active participation and deeper learning by allowing students to interact with content rather than passively consume it, which leads to better retention and understanding of concepts [4]. This approach is particularly effective for struggling learners, as it transforms traditional reading tasks into engaging and interactive experiences.

More specifically, game-based platforms like Roblox have been shown to increase engagement and confidence among Grade 5 learners, particularly those struggling with reading-related skills such as summarizing and inference [5]. The interactive and immersive nature of Roblox allows students to learn through exploration and hands-on activities, making abstract concepts easier to understand. Furthermore, the effectiveness of gamification is supported by research highlighting its ability to improve self-regulation and reading behaviors through elements such as rewards, levels, and feedback systems [6]. These features encourage students to stay motivated, monitor their progress, and take an active role in their learning. Overall, these findings suggest that integrating gamification, especially through interactive platforms like Roblox, can be an effective approach to improving text structure comprehension among Grade 5 students.

References

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